Google: what to study first

1Point3Acres plus other sources, as of October 20, 2026

Bottom line. Study in this order, because it is the order in which topics keep showing up in recent reports: **graphs and search** (BFS, DFS, union-find, topological sort, shortest path, grid and island problems), then **heaps, top-k and interval or meeting-room problems**, then **trees and tries**, then **dynamic programming**, then **arrays, hashing and two pointers**. Greedy, binary search, and object-design style questions come next. Behavioral prep is the most common single item of all, so reserve time for it.

1. Study order and the PDFs that match it

#	Topic	Folder PDF and why now
1	Graphs and search	`03 Graphs and Search`, which holds the island, grid-search and union-find questions. Most frequent topic in every source below.
2	Heaps, top-k, intervals	`04 Heaps, Stacks and Queues`. Meeting rooms, top-k and streaming follow-ups keep coming up.
3	Trees and tries	`05 Trees and Tries`. Router and prefix-tree questions, plus tree merging with rules, were asked this month.
4	Dynamic programming	`02 Dynamic Programming`. Steady, a core Google topic, but fewer dated hits this month than graphs.
5	Arrays, hashing, two pointers	`01 Arrays, Hashing and Two Pointers`. Largest folder, high count, many are quick wins.
6	Greedy, binary search, sorting	`09 Greedy and Math`, `06 Binary Search and Sorting`. Unit-weight knapsack and median of sorted arrays are recent.
7	Design, streaming, scale	`10 Design, Streaming and Scale`, and the scale follow-ups in every PDF.
8	Behavioral and assessment	`11 Other rounds`. The largest topic in the site's own count.

2. The evidence

Our 1Point3Acres question bank, asked in the last 30 days (20 of 73 questions). A question can fit several topics, so the rows overlap.

Topic	Last 30 days	All 73
Graphs and search	9	17
Arrays, hashing, two pointers	7	29
Heaps, stacks, queues	6	14
Grids and simulation	5	16
Greedy and math	5	14
Dynamic programming	3	12
Binary search and sorting	3	9
Strings, parsing, recursion	3	16
Trees and tries	2	12
Design, streaming, scale	2	19

Graph tags alone: graph 6, DFS 4, BFS 3, union-find 2, topological sort 2, shortest path 2, cycle detection 2 of the 20. Seventeen of the 20 are Medium and three are Hard.

1Point3Acres Q2 2026 trends guide (published May 4, 2026, about 60 threads). Hot topics in its own ranking: behavioral (25 or more threads), union-find and friend circles with dynamic connectivity (5), the new work-style hiring assessment (5), ML fundamentals (5), graph shortest path including must-pass nodes (4),

top-k and heap with streaming follow-ups (4), meeting rooms and sweep line (3), number of islands variants (3). Coding stays at LeetCode medium; the guide says the follow-up is where interviews are decided: "what if the input is huge", ladder from in-memory to streaming to external sort to distributed.

PracHub, dated Google coding reports (read October 20, 2026). Of 23 questions dated September to October, its own tags give graphs 5, grids 4, trees 3, arrays and strings 3, then dynamic programming, heaps, intervals, two pointers and greedy at 2 each. Graph and grid questions together are about 9 of 23. These dates are most likely posting dates, not interview dates.

LeetCode's Google 30-day frequency (fetched October 6, 2026). Only 28 problems of those our book matches show any 30-day frequency. Summing their scores by topic: dynamic programming 187, binary search 174, heap 140, arrays and hashing 113, DFS 99, sorting 93, trees 74, linked list 69. The top single problems were Add Two Numbers (69), Palindrome Number (63), Median of Two Sorted Arrays (61), Best Time to Buy and Sell Stock (61), then Group Anagrams, Climbing Stairs and Valid Palindrome (51 each). This list only covers problems already in the book, so treat it as a classic-problem signal, not a full picture.

Newest experience posts on 1Point3Acres (October 16 to 19, 2026). An L4 report: number of islands with BFS, then count enclosed lakes as the follow-up. A tech phone screen: an HTTP router with register and get handlers, solved with a prefix tree and DFS. An intern round: merge two trees with many merge rules (DFS), then the unit-weight bounded knapsack where greedy beats DP and quickselect gives O(n). An onsite: DFS with possible cycles for variable expansion, plus an anagram-style class. One poster noted interviewers asked for several solutions and for the inner workings of the data structures used (how quicksort and a BST are built). A failed onsite was explained by "lack of communication" even with optimal answers.

3. How the format is changing

- Phone screens and onsites run in a plain shared document, with no autocomplete.
- Follow-ups matter more than the first answer: streaming, memory limits, many machines, and edge cases.
- Standalone object-design rounds are more common for L4 (add, delete and random pick in O(1), waitlists, range updates). Be ready to discuss locking.
- The new hiring assessment asks you to pick most and least like me from three work-style statements. Decide your ranking first and stay consistent.
- Communicate while you code. Clarify, state the brute force, then improve it.

4. If you only have a few days

Day 1 to 2: graphs and search, including every island and grid question and one union-find with dynamic connectivity. Day 3: heaps, top-k, and meeting rooms, with the streaming follow-up said out loud. Day 4: trees and tries, with a router. Day 5: dynamic programming, then arrays and hashing for speed. Last day: behavioral stories (about three dense ones), then skim the other-rounds PDF.

5. Limits of this research

These counts come from small, self-reported samples and from tags that overlap, so use them for ordering, not for exact percentages. The 1Point3Acres trends guide is from May, not the last 30 days; the 30-day numbers come from our own question bank, PracHub and the newest posts. A few pages could not be read: the LeetCode discussion compilation of Google questions (blocked) and the Interview Query Google guide (rate limited). I found no Reddit, Blind or Glassdoor reports from September or October 2026, and the general guides I did read (Jobright from January and DG Learning from May, 2026) are older, so they only support the broad picture: arrays and strings, then trees and graphs, then dynamic programming.

Sources. 1Point3Acres Google trends 2026 Q2, 1Point3Acres Google question bank, PracHub Google coding questions, Jobright Google guide, DG Learning L4 list.